

139 Collect runner bean seeds

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MINS

Most plants produce seeds, ranging from tiny poppy seeds to enormous coconuts. Collect and store runner bean seeds properly, and you'll have plenty to plant next year.

What you need

- Scissors
- Brown paper envelopes
- Pencil
- Runner bean plants



1 Leave a few pods on the vine. When they start to dry out and split along the pod center, cut them off near the stem.



2 Open the pod. Remove all the beans, but discard any that are deformed or split. Let them dry out thoroughly.



3 Put them in a brown paper envelope. Store them in a dry, cool place until next year. Then start off new plants by putting one bean in a yogurt cup of soil.

Plant your collected seeds

It's time to transplant your new bean plants when they have grown full leaves.

140 Dry beans for food

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To dry beans for eating, use a needle to pull clean thread through the top third of each bean. String them about 1 in (2.5 cm) apart and hang in a warm, dry, dark place for 1–2 weeks. Store them in an airtight jar.

Dried beans

